GitHub Copilot Cheatsheet (Windows and Linux)

Shortcuts

Tab	Accept the current autocompletion i.e. ghost text. Esc: dismiss the ghost text.
Ctrl+Right arrow	Hold down Ctrl and press right to accept part of the autocompletion
Ctrl+Enter	List the alternative autocompletions
Ctrl+i	Starts the inline chat, or express what you want in a comment. Select some code and hit **Ctrl+i** to start an inline chat about that code. Hit slash **/** in the inline text to list quick prompts. Hit the **Up arrow** to reuse the previous prompts.

Copilot Chat

In the chat there are some prefixes

- @ : chat participant aka agent, an expert in certain subjects
  - @workspace knows your codebase. Slash commands are shorthands for common tasks: `/explain`, `/tests`, `/fix`, `/new`, `/newNotebook`
  - @terminal
  - @vscode
- #: reference to an entity in a prompt
  - #editor : the code visible in the editor
  - #selection : the current selection
  - #terminalLastCommand
  - #terminalSelection

Copilot best practices

- do not let Copilot fly the plane. Do not give it big tasks.
- review the produced code, you are responsible for it.
- just let Copilot point you to the right direction
- context is key: highlight the code that is the object of a prompt.

The 3S principles of prompt engineering: Simple, Specific, Short.

- Simple: solve the simplest possible problem with your prompt
- Specific: the more you ask, the more specific you need to be.
- Short: be short, type less.

Links

- Get to Know Copilot (YouTube video)
- Prompt Engineering with Copilot (YouTube video)
- Copilot Best Practices (YouTube video)
- AI prompts for developers

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